think employment

Think career,
Think new skills,
Think employment.

Helping people to achieve their potential

Start-up Business Plan Template



Prepared by:

Date Completed:

Introduction

A business plan is a planning document that outlines in words and figures your proposed business idea.

This template serves as a guide to help you organise your ideas. However, when considering starting a new business, numerous aspects come into play, and documenting them in black and white can help you identify key areas to consider.

To complete the Start-Up Business Plan fully, you will need to carry out sufficient investigation into customer requirements and local competition, as well as access to
supplies for your business. This procedure in itself is a good exercise in business management, a skill needed by all effective business people.

Your Business Plan is a monitoring tool for you. When you first begin your business, you will have a tremendous number of things to do, and there is always the temptation, once you have started your business, to open up a drawer, drop the Business Plan in, and then forget all about it. But it is essential to keep it close at hand, and to look at it monthly to see how you are progressing. Are you still following the plan? If not, how are you able to rectify the situation?

It is very easy in the early days to feel that you are doing well because you are busy and there is cash in the bank, but you need to keep an eye on the future.

This is your Business Plan – you are responsible for its contents and projections. A Business Plan also needs to be a working document which is monitored and updated regularly.

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Step 1:
Getting Started

Business Information

Details	Response
Name(s) of Owners, Partners or Directors	
Legal Structure (Sole Trader, Partnership, Ltd Company, etc.)	
Business Name (If chosen)	
Business Address and Postcode	
Business Telephone Number	
Business Email Address	
Business Website Address	
Personal Telephone Number	

Step 2:
Executive Summary

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This section should give the reader an overview of your business plan, so we recommend you complete the rest of the plan first. It will summarise your business idea, including its operational base, key customers and competitors, and the people involved.

Additionally, you should include details of any financing required to start the business, what volume of sales you are expecting, and the profit or loss this will generate.

Oh, and don't forget this is meant to be a summary, so try to keep it to one page!



Step 3:
Owner's Background

This section should cover your personal information, qualifications, career history, and experience.

Category	Details
Name	
Career History	
Personality	
Qualifications and Previous Experience	
Motivation/Why do you want to run your own business?	
Training Undertaken	

3.1 Skills Analysis

Skill Area	Skill / Question	Rating (1-5)
Business Skills	Planning	-
	Market Research	-
	Marketing	-
	Financial Forecasting	-
	Book Keeping	-
Occupational Skills	Are you good at what you intend to do?	-
	Do you have a relevant qualification?	-
Personality	Are you committed to this project?	-
	Are you determined to succeed?	-
	Can you handle failure?	-
Key Abilities	Are you a good communicator?	-
	Can you assess risks and make decisions?	-
	Can you lead and direct others?	-

Step 4:
The Business

4.1 An Introduction to The Business

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This section should include a detailed description of what the business will do, how it will meet the needs of your prospective customers and what motivates you to want to set up in the first place. It should also include your short and medium-to-long-term objectives, which can consist of financial goals, sales targets, employee numbers and personal visions of where you want to be as the business develops.

Business Name and Business Type:

(Sole Trader, Ltd Company, Partnership, CIC). If not yet registered, what are you planning to register as?

If you are registered, please provide:

Sole Trader - Unique Tax Reference Number:

Limited Company - Companies House No:

My products/services

My reason(s) for wishing to set up this type of business

How will you fund your business initially?

4.2 Business Objectives

Objective Timeline	Details
Short-term (1 year) objectives for my business	
Medium to Long Term (2-5 years) objectives for my business	
Describe how the skills gained from the bootcamp will help you to achieve sales, gain new customers or opportunities?	

Step 5: The Market

5.1 Market Research - The Customers

Who is your target market?	
Individual Consumers (B2C)	☐
Other Businesses (B2B)	☐
Both	☐

Who are your customers?	
Describe your typical customer:	
Where are your customers based?	
How will they find out about your products or services?	
How many sales/opportunities do you expect to make within six months of completing the bootcamp, and what do you expect the value to be?	
Describe how your product/service will meet a need or solve a problem for your customer? e.g What is the need for your product/service, and how have you identified this?	

5.2 Market Research - Primary and Secondary

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There are two types of market research:

1) Primary – *This is conducted through talking to potential customers, suppliers and any other relevant parties via questionnaires, interviews and focus groups, etc. This will provide you with data that is specific to your business.*

2) Secondary –This research is conducted through researching the market you are entering and finding out basic facts which will help your business. This can be found through government statistics (ons.gov.uk), reliable sources on the internet, published articles, books, etc.

This section should outline what type of research you have carried out and the key findings from this research.

Research Type	Method/Survey Used	Key Findings
Primary		
Secondary		

5.3 Market Research - The Competitors

Competitor (Name, Location, Size)	Promotion Methods	Potential Reaction to Your Business	Advantages You Have	Advantages They Have

Step 6:
Business Risks

6.1 Business S.W.O.T Analysis

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A 'S.W.O.T' Analysis helps you understand the good and bad factors that may affect your business so that you can plan accordingly.

Once you have identified these key areas and listed them below, you can focus on how to overcome them or use them to your advantage.

If you identify that you need more training in a particular area, you should write this in the section 6.2 along with the details of the training course.

Strengths
What do you do well?

Opportunities
What opportunities are available to you?

Weaknesses
Where can you improve?

Threats
What could negatively affect your business?

6.2 Training Needs

Training Course Needed	Provider	Date to Complete

6.3 Contingency Plan

Potential Risk / Issue	Contingency Plan

Step 7:
Marketing - The 7 P's

This section breaks down the 7Ps (as seen below), something which helps with planning, developing, and executing effective marketing strategies. By using an informed and streamlined approach, you will be better able to gain and retain your customers and ensure that you meet and achieve your goals. It is therefore helpful to fill these sections in with as much detail as possible.

1	**Product/ Service**	Defines what your products/services are, including their unique selling points (USPs).	
2	**Price**	The price at which products/services are sold, considering all production, promotion, and delivery costs.	
3	**Place**	The distribution point where customers find your product, such as a website, shop, or third-party retailer.	
4	**Promotion**	Marketing techniques used include social media, a website, email marketing, and PR.	
5	**People**	The employees required for the business to be successful included their number and level of expertise.	
6	**Process**	The processes involved in a product's delivery encompass the website experience, delivery time, and aftercare.	
7	**Physical Evidence**	Everything a customer sees and hears about your product, such as packaging, signage, and confirmation emails.	

Step 8:
Marketing Plan

Marketing Method	How will you implement this?	When	Where	Cost	Return
Social Media					
Website					
Email marketing					
Media Coverage (PR)					



Step 9:
Finance

Category	Item	Cost
Property	Lease Deposit, Rent, Legal Fees	£
Transport	Lease / Rental, Motor Insurance, Road Tax	£
Equipment	Fire and Safety, PPE	£
Marketing	Paid Advertising, Website, Signwriting	£
Admin	Insurance, Professional Fees, Telephone Installation	£
	Total Startup Costs (A)	£

9.2 Start-Up Resources

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Capital equipment items are physical assets with a life span of over a year, acquired for productive activity

Item Description	Already Owned	Still Required
Capital Equipment	£	£
Fixtures & Fittings	£	£
Materials	£	£
Stock	£	£
Total Already Owned (B)	**£**	
Total Required (C)		**£**



9.3 Start-Up Funding Requirements

Description	Calculation	Amount
Total Startup Costs	From 9.1	(A) £
Total Resources Required	From 9.2	(C) £
Working Capital	(Additional funds needed for day-to-day operations)	£
Total Funding Needed		**£**
Less: Owner's Investment	(Cash resources you are providing)	£
External Funding Required		**£**



9.4 Cash Flow Forecast

	Months												
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	Year 1 Total
Cash In													
Sales Revenue													
Other Income													
Total Cash In													
Cash Out													
Stock/ Materials													
Marketing													
Rent													
Salaries													
Other Expenses													
Total Cash Out													
Net Cash Flow													
Opening Balance													
Closing Balance													

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